

Fursa (فرصة)

How to Download and Run This Project

Gaza's Digital Employment Platform • Step-by-Step Setup Guide

What is this project?

Fursa (فرصة) is a bilingual digital employment platform built for Gaza. It connects job seekers with employers through a centralized, trustworthy job board with full Arabic/English support.

Role	What They Can Do
Job Seeker	Browse jobs, apply, save listings, manage applications
Employer	Post job listings, review applications, manage profile
Admin	Approve/reject postings, manage all users and content

What You Will Install (One-Time Setup)

#	Program	What It Does	Download Link
1	Node.js	Runs the website code on your computer	nodejs.org/en/download
2	pnpm	Downloads the packages the project needs	Installed via npm (Step 2)
3	Git	Downloads the project from the internet	git-scm.com/downloads
4	VS Code	A program to view/edit project files	code.visualstudio.com

You also need free accounts on Clerk (clerk.com) for authentication and Neon (neon.tech) for the PostgreSQL database.

Step 1 — Install Node.js

1. Open <https://nodejs.org/en/download> in your web browser.

2. Click the big green LTS button (Recommended For Most Users).
3. Install with all defaults, then open a new terminal and type:

```
node --version
```

You should see something like v22.x.x.

Step 2 — Install pnpm

```
npm install -g pnpm
```

Check it worked:

```
pnpm --version
```

Step 3 — Install Git

Download from <https://git-scm.com/downloads> and install with all defaults. Check it worked:

```
git --version
```

Step 4 — Download the Project

```
cd ~/Desktop
```

```
git clone <YOUR-PROJECT-URL> fursa
```

```
cd fursa
```

Step 5 — Get a Free PostgreSQL Database (Neon)

1. Open <https://neon.tech> and click Sign Up (free, no credit card needed).
2. Create a project named fursa, choose a region close to you.
3. Copy the Connection String (starts with postgresql://...) — you need it in Step 7.

Step 6 — Get Free Clerk Login Keys

1. Open <https://clerk.com> and click Sign Up (free).

2. Create a new application named Fursa.
3. Click Show API Keys and copy both:
 - Publishable key — starts with pk_test_...
 - Secret key — starts with sk_test_...

Step 7 — Configure the .env File

Create a file named exactly .env in the fursa folder and add the following:

```
DATABASE_URL="paste-connection-string-here"
CLERK_PUBLISHABLE_KEY="pk_test_..."
CLERK_SECRET_KEY="sk_test_..."
SESSION_SECRET="any-long-random-string"
PORT=8080
BASE_PATH=/
```

Save the file. Never commit this file to Git — it contains your private keys.

Step 8 — Install Project Pieces

```
pnpm install
```

Takes 1-3 minutes the first time. You only need to do this once.

Step 9 — Set Up Database Tables

```
pnpm --filter @workspace/db run push
```

You should see Changes applied when done.

Step 10 — Start the Project

```
pnpm dev
```

Wait about 10 seconds, then open <http://localhost:22659> in your browser. The Fursa website will appear.

Troubleshooting

command not found: pnpm / node

Close and reopen your terminal after installing Node.js or pnpm.

Missing Clerk Secret Key

- File is named exactly .env (with the dot, no .txt extension)
- File is in the root fursa folder (same folder as package.json)
- Keys start with pk_test_ and sk_test_ with no extra spaces

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Stop the project (Ctrl+C), then run pnpm dev again.

Environment Variables — Quick Reference

Variable	Where to Get It	Required?
DATABASE_URL	Neon dashboard - Connection String	Yes
CLERK_PUBLISHABLE_KEY	Clerk dashboard - Publishable key	Yes
CLERK_SECRET_KEY	Clerk dashboard - Secret key	Yes
SESSION_SECRET	Any long random string	Yes
PORT	Always 8080 for local dev	Yes
BASE_PATH	Always / for local dev	Yes